



Outgoing watchdog notes Chicago’s ‘deficit of legitimacy’ as mayor considers successor

‘THE FACE OF OVERSIGHT’

By Jake Sheridan | CHICAGO TRIBUNE



As Mayor Brandon Johnson mulls her successor, Inspector General Deborah Witzburg has returned to one of her favorite phrases.

Chicago, she told the Tribune during an interview as part of a media tour before she leaves office, “operates at a deficit of legitimacy.”

The leader of this famously corrupt city’s most visible watchdog agency has long described her work as “paying down” that gap in trust. In four years at the helm of the Office of Inspector General, she has certainly presented an invoice.

Her departure gives Johnson a new challenge: Tasked with selecting her successor, the mayor must convince aldermen the person he nominates to follow Witzburg will be a strong independent investigator who will hold him and his administration to account.

The outgoing inspector general — a witty and outspoken leader well-liked in the City Council, disfavored by the mayor and unshy of fight — says she chose to not seek another term, a decision she announced in July after previously making a forceful push to keep the job.

“There’s a huge amount of work left to do, and I’m really proud of the progress we’ve made,” Witzburg said earlier this week. “That is the right time to leave a job like this. I will leave this office more effective and more independent than I found it.”

The confident note she struck ignores the reality complicating her departure, that she probably was not going to get the choice to say.

Witzburg faced bad odds of winning reappointment from Johnson, a frequent target of her politically damaging investigations and opponent in legislative pushes. The mayor

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Departing Chicago Inspector General Deborah Witzburg on South LaSalle Street near her office in the Loop on Thursday. **EILEEN T. MESLAR/TRIBUNE**

‘Millionaire tax’ fails to advance in Springfield

By Jeremy Gornor and Olivia Olander
CHICAGO TRIBUNE

SPRINGFIELD — Illinois Democrats failed Thursday to advance a proposed constitutional amendment that would have asked voters in November to impose an additional tax on residents who earn more than \$1 million a year, exposing divisions within the party over education funding and dealing a blow to their election-year message on affordability.

The House adjourned without voting on the so-called millionaire’s tax resolution, a development that means they will miss a May 3 deadline to place the question on the Nov. 3 general election ballot. The House is not scheduled to return to Springfield until May 5.

The proposal for a 3% tax on the portion of individuals’ net income

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Trump orders use of force to clear key strait

By Jon Gambrell, Jamey Keaten and Aamer Madhani
ASSOCIATED PRESS

DUBAI, United Arab Emirates — President Donald Trump has ordered the U.S. military to “shoot and kill” small Iranian boats that deploy mines in the Strait of Hormuz, he said Thursday, a day after Iran again displayed its ability to thwart traffic through the channel.

Trump’s post on social media came shortly after the U.S. military seized another tanker associated with the smuggling of Iranian oil, ratcheting up a standoff with Tehran over the strait through which 20% of all crude oil and natural gas traded passes.

“I have ordered the United States Navy to shoot and kill any boat, small boats

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“I love my job, I love my students, my kids. But CPS is treating us like we don’t matter. With the money I’m making, I can’t keep up with my rent, my bills or food.”

MARIAN GUTIERREZ, a lunchroom attendant at Mitchell Elementary in West Town



Chicago Public Schools lunchroom workers sit in the street in front of the Chicago Board of Education on Madison Street before being detained by police as an act of civil disobedience on Thursday. **CHRIS SWEDA/CHICAGO TRIBUNE**

Hungry for a contract

By Kate Armanini | CHICAGO TRIBUNE

Hundreds of Chicago Public Schools lunchroom workers rallied outside of the Board of Education Thursday, demanding higher pay as contract negotiations approach the one-year mark.

Clad in navy CPS uniforms, 25 workers linked arms and blocked traffic on Madison Street across from the district’s downtown offices, sitting in silence before they were led away by police.

“I love my job, I love my students, my kids. But CPS is treating us like we don’t matter,”

CPS lunch workers block traffic in protest outside the Chicago Board of Education as contract negotiations hit standstill

said Marian Gutierrez, a lunchroom attendant at Mitchell Elementary in West Town, who was cited and released by officers. “With the money I’m making, I can’t keep up with my rent, my bills or food.”

UNITE HERE Local 1 represents 1,800 lunchroom attendants, cooks and porters, who remain among the lowest-paid employees in the district. The union’s four-year contract expired last June. Bargaining began in early May and has continued monthly.

Earlier this month, district officials proposed

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WEATHER FORECAST

TODAY	SAT.	SUN.
H: 75 L: 46	H: 61 L: 46	H: 64 L: 52

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